Business Model Canvas

Barbershop live-queue marketplace · Deliverable 1.2 · every block is based on our 6 discovery interviews

Key Partners

- Pilot barbershops in New Cairo and Nasr City (the first shops on the marketplace, free first month)
- Barbers with a social following, who share their marketplace profile and live queue link
- Local payment provider (cards and wallets) to collect subscriptions, deposits and, later, commissions
- Cloud hosting and SMS / push notification providers
- Tablet supplier for the in-shop queue screen

Key Activities

- Build and run the marketplace (customer app), the shop screen and the barber app
- Grow both sides of the marketplace: sign shops in person, bring customers through their barbers
- Keep per-barber wait estimates accurate
- Keep interviewing shops and customers; run pilots

Key Resources

- The marketplace platform: shop and barber profiles, live queue, service log, alerts
- Barber ratings and profiles that move with the barber
- Live data on walk-outs, waits and barber demand that no shop records today
- Founding team: product, tech, operations

Value Propositions

- For shops: win back walk-outs (about 10,800 EGP a month at 3 lost cuts a day, our estimate)
- For shops: new customers who find them on a marketplace for barbershops only
- For shops: fewer “is he free?” calls (5–10 a day at the front desk)
- For shops: an automatic service log per barber replaces the paper notebook
- For shops: keeps first come, first served, so walk-ins stay treated fairly
- For customers: find a barber and see the live wait for your own barber, so you arrive just in time
- For customers: a “your barber’s queue is short” alert
- For barbers: a profile and ratings that follow him from shop to shop, plus an open / close queue control

Customer Relationships

- In-person onboarding and support for every shop (COO)
- Free first month, then a monthly subscription
- WhatsApp support line for shop staff
- Self-service marketplace app for customers

Channels

- Direct visits to shops by the founders, later sales reps
- Queue screen and QR code at the shop entrance
- Barbers’ Instagram, TikTok and WhatsApp, linking to their marketplace profile
- Marketplace app and web page

Customer Segments

- Paying customer: owners of multi-chair barbershops (3–8 chairs, 100–250 EGP per cut) in Greater Cairo that work first come, first served and log on paper
- Users: men aged 18–35 loyal to one specific barber
- Users: high-intent clients who found a barber on social media
- Later: customers with no preferred barber, who use the marketplace to find whoever is free nearby

Cost Structure

- Product development: founders’ time now, engineers later
- Cloud hosting, SMS and push notifications
- Queue-screen tablets for shops
- Field sales and onboarding (sales reps from Year 2)
- Payment processing fees on subscriptions
- Marketing with barbers on social media to grow the customer side of the marketplace

Revenue Streams

- Monthly subscription: 1,000 EGP per shop, after a free first month
- Later: a commission on each new customer the marketplace brings to a shop
- Customers and barbers use the marketplace for free
- Revenue grows with shops now, and with marketplace traffic later

Pricing Hypothesis

We charge each shop a monthly subscription of 1,000 EGP, after a free first month. Customers and barbers use the marketplace for free. Later, once the marketplace brings shops new customers, we add a commission on each new customer we bring.

Monetization model

- **Subscription now:** a fixed 1,000 EGP per shop per month (software-as-a-service).
- **Marketplace commission later:** a fee on each new customer the marketplace brings to a shop, never on customers the shop already has.
- **Who pays:** the barbershop. Customers and barbers do not.

Initial price point

1,000 EGP per shop per month (12,000 EGP a year), after a free first month. At Shop 1's price of 120 EGP, that is the value of about 8–9 haircuts a month.

Reasoning

- **Value-based.** Losing 3 haircut customers a day at 120 EGP costs a shop about 10,800 EGP a month (our estimate). 1,000 EGP is under 10% of that: recovering about 9 haircuts a month, one every 3–4 days, pays for the subscription.
- **Simple and predictable.** The owner we interviewed pays for no software today, so a fixed price he knows upfront is easier to accept. A flat fee also removes the two risks of a per-haircut commission: shops hiding cuts to avoid the fee, and owners resisting a fee on every cut.
- **Anchored against competitors.** Fresha charges USD 19.95 a month for an independent professional and USD 14.95 per barber a month for teams. At about 50 EGP per USD, a 5-barber shop on Fresha would pay about 3,700 EGP a month, before its 20% fee on new customers. 1,000 EGP for the whole shop is well below that. Ehgezly does not publish its shop fees.
- **Why the commission comes later.** A fee on new customers only makes sense once the marketplace actually brings them. Fresha shows that shops accept a fee on new marketplace customers; we follow that model once we have traffic, and set the rate below Fresha's 20%.
- **Willingness to pay from interviews.** The owner said, "Of course I'd even pay for a service like that," and was open to a free trial. This is stated, not committed, so we treat it as a signal to test, not as proof.

Risks and how we test them

- **Price too high:** 1,000 EGP is a new monthly cost for shops that pay for no software today.
- **Slow marketplace growth:** if few new customers come through the marketplace, commission revenue arrives later than planned.
- **Milestone 2 test:** after the free month, offer pilot shops the 1,000 EGP subscription and record how many accept. If most refuse, test a lower price or a per-barber price.